

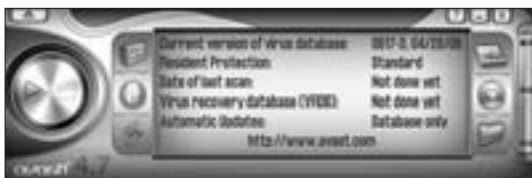
The software is light on system resources and increased the boot-up time by just 7 seconds. It also logged the lowest scan times of 231 seconds in our test scan. While scheduled scanning is supported, e-mail scanning is absent. The outbreak response time of this anti-virus is between four and six hours, which is somewhat comfortable for the user as it leaves the system vulnerable for not very long. You can upgrade to the Premium version for just Rs 1,200 and get additional features such as MailGuard, adware, and spyware detection.

Web site: www.free-av.com/index.htm

Minimum System Requirements: Windows 98 or higher, NT or higher (not Server), 128 MB RAM for Windows 98/ME/NT, 196 MB RAM for Windows XP, IE 5.0

3.2.2.2 avast! 4.7 Home Edition

When we installed and fired up this anti-virus for the first time, we were left wondering whether we had accidentally launched a media player instead. Avast! has the looks of a media player; it even has interface elements that resemble the volume control dial and the play button. What's more, the interface is skinnable. Beneath all the flashy looks, though, beats a reliable anti-virus engine. You can scan your PC with just two clicks, and if you need to scan a particular folder, it is achievable in no more than four. The context menu can also be used to do this.



The snazzy avast! interface is easy on the eyes

A f t e r
installation,
we needed to
r e s t a r t
W i n d o w s ,
when it per-
formed a
b o o t - t i m e

scan. Incidentally, such a bootup scan can be scheduled to run each time Windows boots. It even supports scanning files being transferred using P2P agents and instant messengers.